

Thursday, 1 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

20° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

18° 13°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

17° 13°

GLASGOW

Overcast

15° 11°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Residents near RAF Fairford left 'like sitting ducks'.

Villagers living near the base say a lack of communication in the days before and after the incident has left them feeling unsafe.

UK · NEWS

2

Brexit referendum 'possible' in Labour election manifesto, says Burnham.

The PM says a referendum wouldn't be the right thing now but the UK needs to consider its options for the future.

POLITICS · UK

3

Burnham 'really concerned' if Man City owners sell up after rule breaches.

The prime minister compares the allegations against Man City to the plight of his own club Everton.

POLITICS · UK

4

Tapestry tour added for blind after legal threat.

The British Museum will offer an audio-described Bayeux Tapestry tour after a blind man's legal threat.

UK · NEWS

5

Teens who died in car that entered river named.

Jackson Duke, Luke Etheridge and Zara Shaw died when the car they were in ended up in the River Wear.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Dame Esther Rantzen: That's Life! presenter, Childline founder and campaigner for assisted dying.**
The star presented That's Life! for two decades and set up two national helplines, including Childline.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Sussexes condemn 'reckless intrusion' after photographer spotted near Archie and Lilibet's school.**
One of two men seen outside the UK school attended by the children is understood to be an international press photographer.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 US actor Chad Lowe 'heartbroken' by death of daughter Fiona aged 13.**
Lowe and his wife Kim Painter announce the death of their daughter, who "was the light of our lives".
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Lady A singer Charles Kelley reveals blood cancer diagnosis.**
The Grammy-winning US country music star, 45, says he currently feels "great" and is "hopeful".
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Oasis take legal action to stop sale of unheard tapes.**
The auction house said it was "very disappointed" the lot could no longer be sold.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Punish Man City this season, say other club chiefs.**
Manchester City's punishment for breaching Premier League rules should be handed down before the end of this season, senior football figures tell BBC Sport.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Burnham 'really concerned' if Man City owners sell up after rule breaches.**
The prime minister compares the allegations against Manchester City to the plight of his own club Everton.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Ronaldo leaves Portugal camp after coach denies rift.**
Cristiano Ronaldo says he has left Portugal's international camp and will explain why "in time", hours after head coach Jorge Jesus denied any rift with the player.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Respect and laughs as Fury and Joshua face off.**
After more than a decade of public feuding and false starts, Tyson Fury and Anthony Joshua exchange pleasantries, trade jokes and even discuss going for a pint at a news conference in London.
SPORT · UK
- 5 Saracens boss Venter skips more media duties.**
Saracens director of rugby Brendan Venter misses a second pre-match media conference, as head coach Joe Shaw attends.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A delightful trend has emerged in local parks: 'community notice boards' dedicated solely to happy news.**
People are sharing positive local stories, lost-and-found successes, and charming drawings, creating a lovely hub of optimism for passers-by.
- 2 Research is highlighting the surprising joy found in 're-reading a beloved childhood book'.**
Experts suggest that revisiting these familiar tales can offer a comforting escape and a wonderful dose of nostalgia in our busy lives.
- 3 A charming movement sees people 'collecting unusual old buttons' from flea markets and antique shops.**
These tiny treasures, with their unique designs and histories, are being repurposed into jewellery or displayed as miniature works of art.
- 4 The simple pleasure of 'writing a letter to your future self' is gaining popularity.**
Many are finding it a thoughtful way to reflect on personal growth and look forward to aspirations, often opened years later for a lovely surprise.
- 5 Experts are noting a rise in interest for 'vintage board game nights' as a way to connect with friends.**
These evenings often involve classic games from yesteryear, fostering light-hearted competition and plenty of laughter without screens.
- 6 A new report suggests that 'the satisfying ritual of polishing silverware' is experiencing a quiet revival.**
Far from a chore, many are discovering the meditative qualities of bringing a shine back to cherished family heirlooms.
- 7 The delightful art of 'creating miniature garden scenes' in terracotta pots is bringing unexpected joy to many.**
These tiny landscapes, complete with small plants and charming accessories, are a perfect way to bring a touch of whimsy to any windowsill.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new pack of biscuits, especially if it's a fancy selection. What is it?

ANSWER: ARRANGING THEM BY PREFERRED EATING ORDER.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE INSIDE OF THE EMPTY PACKET AFTER POURING THEM OUT.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular sound' just instantly transports you back to a specific memory or feeling, perhaps from your childhood or a happy holiday?

Is there a specific sound – maybe the distant chimes of an ice cream van, the crunch of autumn leaves, or the crackle of a log fire – that always makes you feel wonderfully nostalgic?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday household item' that, despite its simplicity, you genuinely couldn't imagine your life without because it's just so useful or brings you a little bit of joy, don't we?

What's that one unassuming item in your home – perhaps a trusty tea towel, a favourite mug, or a surprisingly versatile kitchen gadget – that you truly couldn't do without, and why?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that penguins can actually fly, but only when they are very young and before their wings fully develop for swimming?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically one-hundredth of a second.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- Strawberries are the only fruit that wear their seeds on the outside.
- The inventor of the frisbee was turned into a frisbee after he died.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on all the beaches on Earth.

On this day

Day 274 of the year, 91 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (South Korea); Beginning of the United States' Fiscal Year; Children's Day (El Salvador, Guatemala, Sri Lanka); Christian feast day: Abai (Syriac Orthodox Church). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Martin Turner, English singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1962 — Esai Morales, American actor
- 1948 — Cub Koda, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2000)
- 1968 — Kevin Griffin, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 2006 — Priah Ferguson, American actress
- 1987 — Matthew Daddario, American actor
- 1973 — John Mackey, American composer
- 1973 — Christian Borle, American actor and singer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2024 — Israel invaded Southern Lebanon, marking the fifth Israeli invasion of Lebanon since 1978.
- 1982 — Helmut Kohl replaces Helmut Schmidt as Chancellor of Germany through a constructive vote of no confidence.
- 2014 — A double bombing of an elementary school in Homs, Syria kills over 50 people.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2000 — Israeli–Palestinian conflict: Palestinians protest the killing of 12-year-old Muhammad al-Durrah by Israeli police in northern Israel, beginning the "October 2000 events".
- 2001 — 3G wireless technology first becomes available when it is adopted by Japanese telecommunications company NTT Docomo.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1987 — The 5.9 Mw Whittier Narrows earthquake shakes the San Gabriel Valley with a Mercalli intensity of VIII (Severe), killing eight and injuring 200.
- 2015 — Heavy rains trigger a major landslide in Guatemala, killing 280 people.

- 2014 — A series of explosions at a gunpowder plant in Bulgaria completely destroys the factory, killing 15 people.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 275 of the year, 90 days left in 2026. Today Batik Day (Indonesia); Christian feast day: Blessed Antoine Chevrier; Christian feast day: Denha I of Tikrit (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Blessed Jan Beyzym. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1970 — Kelly Ripa, American actress and talk show host
- 1960 — Django Bates, English musician and composer
- 1949 — Richard Hell, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1988 — Brittany Howard, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1958 — Robbie Nevil, American singer-songwriter
- 1941 — Diana Hendry, English poet and author
- 1929 — Moses Gunn, American actor (died 1993)
- 1976 — Mark Chilton, English cricketer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2002 — The Beltway sniper attacks begin in Washington, D.C., extending over three weeks and killing 10 people.
- 1970 — An aircraft carrying the Wichita State University football team, administrators, and supporters crashes in Colorado, killing 31 people.
- 2016 — Ethiopian protests break out during a festival in the Oromia region, killing dozens of people.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1996 — The Electronic Freedom of Information Act Amendments are signed by U.S. President Bill Clinton.
- 1968 — Mexican President Gustavo Díaz Ordaz orders soldiers to suppress a demonstration of unarmed students, ten days before the start of the 1968 Summer Olympics.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar